

by town policy, no emergency vehicles or police vehicle is allowed in
Councilman Jack Hassen said he did not know the answer to the

the younger generation through the

Sayers was born May 20, 1915

Injured American bald eagle treated in Ahoskie

By Lucy Wallace
Staff Writer

AHOSKIE — The American Bald Eagle, a majestic bird who surprisingly inhabits this area of the United States, is, as we all know, America's national bird.

The Ahoskie Animal Hospital, located on Highway 13 South, got a rare opportunity to get up close and personal with such an Eagle Sunday.

Apparently the bird (it was not known what sex it was) was hit by a car and found in Camden County last week on the side of the road. North Carolina Wildlife officials were contacted and the bird was taken to the home of Benjie and Amy Brown in Colerain.

The Browns are licensed to rehabilitate birds of all kinds, including birds of prey. According to Amy Brown, "They brought him to me Sunday." She then called Dr. Proctor who took the bird, giving it fluids and food.

Proctor said the Eagle was given intravenous fluids and force fed chicken gizzards. "He appeared to be weak and dehydrated and was possibly suffering from a concussion," stated Proctor.

The remedy and care must have

worked. Monday Proctor said, "He is standing up and looking much better today." The eagle weighed nine pounds.

During his residency at AAH, the eagle shared room and board with another raptor, a fully grown but tiny, screech owl who had also been hit by a vehicle. Raptors are birds of prey.

Monday afternoon the bird was shipped to Greenville where he was to be loaded onto a USAir flight to Charlotte and his final destination, The Carolina Raptor Center.

Brown indicated the bird was an immature eagle, "less than four years old." American Bald Eagles don't get their distinctive white head feathers until after they are four years old. "Usually by the time we get birds like this, they can't be helped because they've been shot or badly hurt by cars. I can't think of a better one to make it, than the Eagle," she stressed.

Brown further noted, "They (eagles) seem to be making a comeback in this area. I noticed a couple of them on the Chowan River last year."

Once the young bird arrives in

(See EAGLE, Page 5A)

the younger generation through the



Injured eagle

Dr. Pat Proctor, veterinarian at Ahoskie Animal Hospital holds up an American Bald Eagle that was being treated for dehydration and possible concussion after apparently being hit by a car in Camden County. Dr. Proctor gave the majestic bird fluids and food and insisted that he was doing much better. The national bird was an immature bald

eagle, under four years old, as he hadn't developed his distinctive white feathers on top. Monday afternoon, the eagle was transported to The Carolina Raptor Center in Charlotte, where he will be rehabilitated and eventually released back into the wild. (Photo by Lucy Wallace)

Wednesday
March 25, 1992 edition
(The News-Herald)

Eagle

(From Page 1A)

Charlotte at the Raptor Center, he will undergo extensive rehabilitation and, depending on his progress, hopefully released back into the wild.

Pat Marcum, executive director of the Center, explained the process. "First we'll determine what we think is wrong. He will receive an intensive examination and treatment will be determined by the diagnosis."

Marcum noted the Center has x-ray equipment available and if needed the eagle would be x-rayed. "During the first period of the stay, he will be kept in an intensive care hospital. If he recovers quickly then he will be moved outside to a rehabilitation cage to get his/her bearings."

She continued, "Once he is moving around well, he will be moved to a flight cage. We have a 40 foot flight cage but are raising funds now to build a 96 foot cage specifically for eagles." Marcum indicated another eagle staying at the Center had been shot and both eagles would benefit from the larger

cage.

Once rehabilitated, the bird will be released if he does well. Where he is released is decided upon later but is based upon several factors depending on the individual bird, including migratory routine.

As far as the number of American Bald Eagles in North Carolina, Marcum maintained, "We do have a few nesting bald eagles in the state, but not as many as South Carolina. Slowly but surely they are making a comeback but they are not by any means off the Endangered Species List. We have to leave them some undisturbed habitat for them to be able to thrive."

The Carolina Raptor Center is a non-profit group that does accept tax-exempt donations. Marcum said if anyone was interested in donating to the new eagle cage to send their pledge to Carolina Raptor Center, P.O. Box 16443, Charlotte, NC 28297. The telephone number is 704-875-6521.

If the Eagle who spent the night in Ahoskie is released back here in the area he was found, The Raptor Center promised to contact *The News-Herald*.